🎮 Game Jam Starter Kit & Pocket Grimoire

GEEKGIRLCON 2026 • ROOM 'AMERICA' • SUNDAY, OCT 25 @ 1:30 PM

OFFICIAL TAKE-HOME GUIDE

👥 The 5 Jam Crew Archetypes (Zero Coding Required!)



Code Wizard
Game logic, movement, camera, turning bugs into hilarious features.



Visual Alchemist
Color palettes, 2D sprites, UI, 3D models, textures, animations.



Audio Bard
Banging loops, crunch sound effects, atmospheric tension, voice.



World Architect
Narrative, player choices, dialogue trees, game lore, rules.



Guild Guide
Scope keeper, clock tracker, snack provider, team cheerleader!

⚡ Veteran Cheat Codes: Surviving the 48 Hours

1. The "One Atomic Verb"

Don't build Skyrim in a weekend. Pick **ONE single action** (*Jump*, *Brew*, *Rotate*, *Shout*, *Catch*) and make that one interaction feel delightful before adding anything else.

2. The Scope Butcher Knife

Saturday 8 PM: Cut 50% of your planned features.
Sunday 10 AM: Cut 50% of what is left.
A tiny finished toy with one level beats a broken main menu every single time.

3. Evie's Mindset Hack

"Some of my most awesome outcomes came when I decided to learn something new rather than win. If you're a coder, do audio or design. And actually sleep!"

4. The "License to Fail"

In a studio, failure costs thousands of dollars. In a game jam, failure costs 48 hours and leaves you with an unforgettable story and a skill you will keep forever.

🛠️ Free Beginner Engines to Start Tonight

Twine (twinery.org)
Zero code. Interactive narrative, choose-your-own-adventure, exports to HTML.

Bitsy (ledoux.itch.io/bitsy)
Run directly in your browser. Tiny lo-fi 8-bit walking simulators and pixel art.

Godot Engine (godotengine.org)
100% free, lightweight, open-source 2D and 3D engine with Python-like script.

Phaser / itch.io (itch.io/jams)
HTML5 browser games. Join hundreds of beginner jams happening every weekend!

🎴 Panelist Roster & Community Launchpads

SCAN TO EXPLORE PROJECTS, GAMES, AND PACIFIC NORTHWEST INDIE NETWORKS

SCAN WITH PHONE CAMERA

🌟 Connect with Your Panelists

Larry James
Moderator • UpLiftVR / Wulf Design
wulfdesign.github.io

Tim Cullings
Executive Director • Seattle Indies
timcullings.carrd.co

Heather Coles
Creative Director • Orbicular Games
linktr.ee/heathercoles

Renee Gittins
Studio Head • Stumbling Cat
potionsacurioustale.com

Dr. Evie Powell
Staff Software Engineer • Niantic Spatial
linkedin.com/in/evie-powell-phd-b078b43/

Seattle Indies Hub
PNW Non-Profit Game Dev Community
seattleindies.org

🚀 Your Quest Awaits: 3 Immediate Next Steps

1. Visit the Seattle Indies Gaming Hall

Head downstairs right now to the **Skagit Lower Level / 3rd Floor**! Play dozens of indie games created right here in the Pacific Northwest, chat with local developers, and fly in **UpLiftVR** firsthand.

2. Join the Seattle Indies Discord

Hop onto **seattleindies.org** and join over 5,000 local developers. Attend free bi-weekly socials, monthly playtests, and find team members for upcoming local jams.

3. Mark Global Game Jam 2027

Every January, thousands of developers across 100+ countries make games simultaneously over 48 hours. Seattle hosts some of the largest GGJ sites in North America—completely beginner friendly!

4. The 3-Prompt Spark Challenge

Remember today's seeds: **Theme + Atomic Verb + Bizarre Twist**. Pick a weekend, invite two friends, make coffee, and build a game you love.

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